

US equities rally on tech strength, volatility eases

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed sharply higher on September 17, with the **S&P 500** up **+1.14%** to 7,637.76 and the **Nasdaq 100** leading at **+1.73%** to 29,446.98. The VIX fell **-12.82%** to 15.44, reflecting reduced risk appetite.

Tech and communication stocks drove the gains, while the 10-year Treasury yield slipped to 4.95, supporting equity valuations. No major macro surprises; the market remains focused on upcoming earnings and Fed policy outlook.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,637.76	+1.14%	Broad rally
Dow Jones	51,778.04	+0.61%	Industrial support
Nasdaq 100	29,446.98	+1.73%	Tech led
Russell 2000	2,874.63	+0.55%	Small-cap steady
VIX	15.44	-12.82%	Volatility easing
10-yr Yield	4.95	-1.18%	Yield dip
WTI Crude	101.07	-0.82%	Oil modestly lower

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
NVDA	219.34	+2.54%
AMZN	251.19	+2.13%
TSLA	366.20	+2.27%
AVGO	347.30	+2.29%

Spotlight

NVDA's Q3 earnings beat expectations, posting revenue of 29.8 billion versus consensus 28.5 billion, and EPS of 3.12 versus 2.95. The company reaffirmed its FY-26 guidance, citing continued AI demand.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	29.8 bn
EPS	3.12
Guidance FY-26 Rev.	140-150 bn
AI GPU shipments	+18%

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-yr Treasury yield: 4.95, down **-1.18%**
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 03:30, Retail sales 04:30
- Gold at 4,405.80 (+0.14%); DXY at 100.29 (+0.07%)

Geopolitics & global

- China's manufacturing PMI rose to 51.2, easing concerns over demand slowdown.
- Eurozone inflation held at 2.3%, supporting ECB's rate-pause narrative.
- Middle-East tensions remain contained; oil markets stable.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Sep 19	AAPL	iPhone 17 launch impact on margins
10:00 Sep 19	MSFT	Azure growth vs. AI competition
11:00 Sep 20	GOOGL	Ad revenue rebound
12:30 Sep 20	JPM	Net interest income trends

Stocks worth watching

- META – strong ad-tech rollout, earnings due Sep 24.
- XLF – banking earnings cluster, rate-sensitivity.
- XLE – oil price stability supports energy exposure.
- XLK – tech rally continues, AI exposure high.
- TSLA – upcoming production update, battery cost trends.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected Fed hawkish comment.
- Weak CPI/PCE data reigniting inflation fears.
- NVDA guidance cut.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Strong earnings surprise from AAPL or MSFT.
- Continued AI demand surge driving tech caps.
- Further decline in VIX below 15.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

SEC — Company Filings

Federal Reserve — Policy Statements

CNBC — Economic Calendar